Beacon Digest -- 2026-10-14

Linux

[$] KDE Linux at two

Source: LWN.net

> KDE Linux , the KDE Project's second stab at creating its own distribution, was first introduced as "Project Banana" at the Akademy conference in 2024 by Harald Sitter. Nate Graham announced the first alpha-quality release during Akademy 2025 . Graham and Sitter paired up at Akademy 2026 to provide...

Nix and Lix local root-privilege-escalation vulnerabilities

Source: LWN.net

> The Lix and Nix projects have jointly disclosed a set of vulnerabilities that can be used to escalate privileges to root on systems running the Lix or Nix daemons. " All systems that build untrusted derivations are affected. " Releases with fixes from each project are available today. CVE IDs have n...

[$] Owning C types from Rust code

Source: LWN.net

> Rust's system of ownership and borrowed references is convenient when it can correctly model a program's needs. The Rust for Linux project has worked to provide adapters between Rust's semantics and the existing C code in the kernel. At Kangrejos 2026, Andreas Hindborg spoke about a patch series imp...

Eisentraut: The reverts will continue until morale improves

Source: LWN.net

> PostgreSQL core team member Peter Eisentraut has written a blog post reflecting on the " unusually high number of features " that have been taken out of the upcoming PostgreSQL 19 release since the beta period began. Some of the reverted features had significant architectural defects that would have...

Security updates for Tuesday

Source: LWN.net

> Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (cjose, curl, emacs, environment-modules, flatpak, flatpak-builder, gd, glibc, kernel, libxml2, pcre2, and rsyslog),

> Debian (chromium, keystone, libgit2, librsvg, nagios4, and ntfs-3g), Fedora (baresip, bcm283x-firmware, curl, flare-im, GitPython, iperf...

Asterinas 0.19.0 released

Source: LWN.net

> Asterinas is a project to build a new operating-system kernel in Rust; it was covered here in 2025. Version 0.19.0 of the Asterinas kernel has been released; changes include a new graphics subsystem capable of running X.org, " minimal but usable " 64-bit Arm support, better virtualization support, a...

What’s old is new: Lightwell discovers novel zero-day vulnerability in core Java framework

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Enterprise IT runs on decades-old foundational code. The prevailing assumption around these mature components is that if code has been sitting untouched in production for ten years without breaking, it must be safe. Libraries like the Eclipse Implementation of Jakarta XML Binding (JAXB) quietly powe...

How AI is defining the ‘new’ architect

Source: Red Hat Blog

> For decades, enterprise architecture focused on diagrams and system designs. Today, AI and autonomous agents are shifting the paradigm by automating technical execution—generating code and infrastructure in minutes. Thinking ahead to the future, this will belong to the Cognitive Architect—a leader w...

Security

AI-Found Linux Kernel Flaw Gives Local Users Root, and Can Break a Guest Out to the Host

Source: The Hacker News

> A flaw in Linux's vhost subsystem lets a local user read and write kernel memory at will and become root across nearly a decade of kernel versions. In one virtualization setup, it lets an untrusted virtual machine write to the host's memory and hijack the program that runs the virtual machine. The b...

Four-Byte Write and Timing Bug Let Researchers Run Code in Windows SmartScreen Enclave

Source: The Hacker News

> Security researchers ran their own code inside a protected part of Windows that is meant to stay sealed off even when the rest of the computer is taken over. The protected area is a VBS enclave, an isolated slice of memory the operating system uses to guard secrets, and the one they broke into handl...

Microsoft Patches Record 1,413 Flaws, Including Exploited Windows Shell Bug

Source: The Hacker News

> Microsoft on Tuesday shattered its own Patch Tuesday record by shipping patches for a whopping 1,413 vulnerabilities, including one that it said has come under active exploitation. These include 1,102 flaws in Windows, 134 in Office, 61 in Developer Tools, 36 in SharePoint Server, and 22 in SQL Serv...

OpenAI Employee Arrested for Allegedly Planting Hidden Recorder in Executive Conference Room

Source: The Hacker News

> A Saudi National and employee of OpenAI has been arrested for allegedly planting a hidden recording device in an executive conference room at the company's San Francisco offices to covertly record sensitive conversations. Abdulrahman Alfozan, 35, has been charged with using or endeavoring to use an...

Anthropic Warns Small AI Models Could Soon Form Self-Propagating IoT Botnets

Source: The Hacker News

> Small artificial intelligence (AI) models may be months away from developing capabilities to self-replicate on IoT devices like smart ovens and off-brand Android TV boxes, according to a warning from Anthropic. The frontier AI lab said small AI models could form autonomous, self-propagating worm bot...

Docker Fixes Critical Two-Year-Old Hub Flaw That Let One User Push Images as Another

Source: The Hacker News

> A flaw in Docker Hub, the registry where container images are published and downloaded, let one user push, pull, or delete images as another user. Docker fixed the flaw on September 30 and says it found no evidence that anyone exploited it. The flaw was in the feature that converts a personal accoun...

Attacker Chains Three Ivanti Connect Secure Zero-Days for Root Access, Only Two Patched So Far

Source: The Hacker News

> An attacker chained three zero-day flaws in Ivanti Connect Secure, a VPN appliance, to run commands as root without logging in, security firm Volexity said on October 13. Ivanti has released fixes for two of the flaws and told customers on affected versions to "act immediately." A fix for the third...

SAP Discloses Critical CVSS 10 Flaw in Cloud SDK for Python Allowing OAuth2 Credential Theft

Source: The Hacker News

> A flaw in SAP's Cloud SDK for Python can send an application's OAuth2 client credentials to a server an attacker controls, SAP said in a security advisory on October 13. The flaw affects multi-tenant applications on SAP Business Technology Platform (BTP) that use the SDK, SAP's official Python clien...

GitHub Tightens npm Publishing After Flaw Left 1,500+ Packages Vulnerable to Hijacking

Source: The Hacker News

> GitHub has taken the step of expiring unvalidated npm trusted publishing configurations 48 hours after creation after researchers found that it was possible for an attacker to push new versions of a different user's package without having to steal their credentials. "Your configuration becomes valid...

Xandr Fined a Record €8.6 Million for Relaying Grindr Data Revealing Sexual Orientation

Source: The Hacker News

> The Norwegian Data Protection Authority (DPA) has fined Xandr, an advertising unit owned by Microsoft, €8.6 million ($9.62 million) for illegally relaying Grindr users' sensitive data to advertisers. The administrative penalty is the largest issued by the data protection watchdog, arguing the case...

[Webinar] How to Stop AI-Driven Privilege Escalation With Runtime Identity Controls

Source: The Hacker News

> The dangerous part of a stolen identity isn't always the initial login. It's what an attacker can do with that access next. With AI accelerating reconnaissance, exploitation of vulnerabilities, and privilege escalation, attackers can move through systems faster than security teams can investigate. A...

General Tech

Starlink limit hits Ukraine's drones. The battlefield depends on SpaceX

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://defence24.com/geopolitics/starlink-limit-hits-ukraines-drones-the-battlefield-depends-on-spacex Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50084622 Points: 13 # Comments: 2

What agents mean for Rust (and vice versa)

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://smallcultfollowing.com/babysteps/blog/2026/10/14/agentic-dev-and-rust/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50084416 Points: 6 # Comments: 0

Iosevka is an open-source, sans-serif and slab-serif, monospace font

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://typeof.net/Iosevka/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50084240 Points: 41 # Comments: 12

AOSP Source Releases Are So Late Developers Disassemble Libraries to Report Bugs

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/android/ndk/issues/2260 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50083130 Points: 244 # Comments: 115

Felix Rieseberg Homepage

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://felixrieseberg.com/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50082470 Points: 186 # Comments: 76

Strafe: A new open-source, E2E Encrypted, and federated alternative to Discord

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://strafe.chat/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50082021 Points: 19 # Comments: 7

Grace Hopper Celebration Cancelled

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://anitab.org/press-release Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50080007 Points: 191 # Comments: 118

Recreational Programming

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.cphiri.dev/presentations/recreational-programming Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50079865 Points: 188 # Comments: 76

AlphaNIST

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://alpha-nist.github.io/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50079464 Points: 76 # Comments: 25

PostEra (YC W20) Is Hiring AI Researchers for Drug Discovery

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://jobs.lever.co/postera/c7d50a36-db0a-4574-bfe4-8700b74a22c0 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50078686 Points: 0 # Comments: 0

OpenAI engineer arrested in bugging of executive conference room

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> https://x.com/OpenAINewsroom/status/2110095403198849132 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50078141 Points: 585 # Comments: 480

Show HN: Guitoro, a virtual guitar you strum with your keyboard

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Guitoro is a free browser guitar using recordings of real instruments. You can strum with your keyboard, mouse, or touchscreen, choose acoustic, classical, electric guitar or bass, and see chord fingering and each stroke. Song practice can be slowed to 20%, and there are free chord tools and tuners....

Show HN: XY Music Notation

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> I've been playing around with a new kind of isomorphic music keyboard that uses a base-12 notation, and wanted some sheet music to learn some new music for it.

> The idea is to represent each note in 12-TET as a number, so N ∈ (0,1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,9,X,Y). I used codex to build a music score rendering ba...

Show HN: How random are you?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://lab.specr.net/rigged-draw/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50074909 Points: 148 # Comments: 75

Gemini 4 Argon

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> See also: Gemini 4 Argon for Robotics - https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50074869 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50073879 Points: 1302 # Comments: 907

Redesigning source control at Anthropic

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.anthropic.com/engineering/redesigning-source-control Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50073633 Points: 773 # Comments: 777

The United Kingdom generates less electricity per person than in the 1970s

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://ourworldindata.org/data-insights/electricity-generation-per-person-in-the-united-kingdom-has-fallen-by-a-third-from-its-early-2000s-peak Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50072994 Points: 312 # Comments: 477

Thunderbird for iOS

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://blog.thunderbird.net/2026/10/thunderbird-for-ios-a-first-look-at-the-native-iphone-email-app-in-development/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50072913 Points: 437 # Comments: 185

Same Job, Two Engines: InnoDB and Iceberg Internals

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://marcpaul.io/logs/same-job-two-engines-innodb-and-iceberg-internals/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50071466 Points: 8 # Comments: 0

Apple HomeView

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.apple.com/apple-homeview/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50071017 Points: 728 # Comments: 851